Revision Date:
11/01/2024

Background:
Processing standards are set in place to ensure the application process is completed within state mandated timeframes.

Purpose:
This section outlines time limit guidelines for applications and processing delays. This section is being revised due to sunset review.

Policy:
All applications must be processed at the earliest extent possible upon receipt, but no later than the 30th day from the date of application. If eligibility is not determined and the opportunity to participate is not provided within 30 days of the application date, it will result in untimely processing.

Processing guidelines for required actions during the initial 30 days of the application are outlined in CalFresh Processing Guide 109-01 Time Limits and Delays.

1. Exceptions to Denials on the 30th Day

Exceptions to processing guidelines apply to applications where the 30th day from the file date falls on a non-business day. When this occurs, the application must be denied on the following business day. Refer to examples below:

Example 1	
Scenario	The 30th day from the application file date falls on Wednesday, Christmas Day.
Outcome	Deny the application on Thursday, the next business day.
Example 2	
Scenario	The 30th day from the application file date falls on a Sunday and Monday is a holiday.
Outcome	Deny the application on Tuesday, the next business day.

2. Delayed Processing

When processing a delayed action, first determine the cause. Eligibility determination delays will be categorized as either household (HH) or county caused.

When the HH has failed to complete the application process despite the county's actions to assist, establish a HH caused delay. When the county has failed to complete the required actions, establish a county caused delay. Refer to table below for HH caused reasons and county required actions.

If the HH fails to…	**then the county required action is to…**
complete application forms,	offer or attempt to offer, assistance in its completion.

provide complete verification,	provide the HH with a list of required verifications on the Request for Verifications (CW 2200) form and offer assistance in obtaining the verifications. Give the HH at least 10 days from the date of the initial request to provide missing verification.
appear to their initial interview,	issue a Notice of Missed Interview (NOMI) CF 386. If the HH requests to be rescheduled within the initial 30-day period, then schedule a second interview.

If the HH…	then…
postpones the second interview or cannot be rescheduled until after the 20th day, but before the 30th day from the date of application,	the HH must appear for their interview, provide verification, and register members for work by the 30th day. Otherwise, the delay is the fault of the HH.
fails to appear to their initial interview and the second interview is postponed at the HH's request until after 30th day from the date the application was filed,	delay is fault of the HH.
has missed both scheduled interviews and requests another interview,	any delay is fault of the HH.

Note: A denial action cannot be taken if the 10 days from the request for verification have not elapsed even if the due date is past the 30th day.

3. Delays Beyond 30th Day

If the application cannot be processed by the end of the 30-day processing period due to the fault of the HH, deny the application on the 30th day and the HH will lose their entitlement to benefits for the month of application. However, give the HH an additional 30 days from the date of denial to take the required action.

When the application is denied, send the HH a denial NOA on the 30th day notifying the HH of the action required to complete the application. If the HH takes the required action within the second 30-day period (within 60 days from the application file date), a new application is not required to make an eligibility determination.

If the HH responds during the second 30-day processing period and is found to be…	then…
eligible,	prorate benefits from the date the HH provided all required verifications and completed actions.
ineligible,	deny the application and provide the HH with a denial NOA.

If the HH does not take the required actions within the second 30-day processing period, take no further action. The HH must re-apply.

When a delay in the initial 30-day application processing period is the fault of the county, take immediate corrective action. Do not deny the application unless otherwise ineligible. Process the application and send the DFA 377.1A NOA to inform the HH of the pending processing of their application by the 30th day of the application file date.

- If the case documentation is insufficient to determine eligibility, inform the HH of any actions or verifications that are required to complete the application process.
- If the HH fails to respond during the second 30-day processing period, deny the application and take no further action.

If the HH is determined eligible during the second 30-day processing period, then provide benefits back to the date of the application file date. If the HH is determined ineligible during the second 30-day processing period, then deny the application and send a denial NOA.

4. Delays Beyond 60 Days

When processing delays beyond the initial and second 30-day processing period (beyond 60 days), the cause of delay(s) must first be reviewed to determine the HH's eligibility and benefit issuance date. Refer to table below for guidance on processing delays beyond 60 days.

<table>
<tr><th>If at the end of the second 30-day processing period the…</th><th>then…</th></tr>
<tr><td>HH is at fault for not completing the application process,</td><td>the HH must file a new application to participate.</td></tr>
<tr><td>county is at fault for not completing the application process and the case documentation is sufficient to determine eligibility,</td><td>continue to process the original application and any supplemental information provided by the HH until an eligibility determination is made. If the HH is determined eligible, benefit entitlement will be determined as follows:

<table>
<tr><th>Initial 30-day Delay</th><th>2nd 30-day Delay</th><th>Benefit Entitlement Date</th></tr>
<tr><td>County caused</td><td>County caused</td><td>Application file date.</td></tr>
<tr><td>HH caused</td><td>County caused</td><td>Date all required verifications were received and all actions completed.</td></tr>
</table>

If the HH is ineligible, deny the application and send a denial NOA.</td></tr>
<tr><td>county is at fault for not completing the application process and the case documentation is insufficient to determine eligibility,</td><td>continue to process the original application and send the HH a DFA 377.1A NOA informing the HH of the pending status of the application. Inform the HH of the actions necessary to complete application process, allow at least 10 days to take required actions specified on the NOA. If the HH fails to take required action, deny the application.</td></tr>
</table>

Procedure:
CalFresh Program Guide (CFPG) 63-1103 Definitions and Examples.
CalFresh Processing Guide 109-01 Time Limits and Delays.

Other Program Impacts:
None.

References:
All County Letter (ACL) 15-93, 17-55.
All County Information Notice (ACIN) I-14-06, I-58-08.
Manual of Policy and Procedures (MPP) Sections 63-301.3, 63-301.4.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 10/31/2027.

Approval for Release:

11-22-24

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services